



GRADE 12- ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

SECTION 1 – WORD AND STRUCTURE KNOWLEDGE

Questions 1–30 | 1 mark each

Q1. Choose the word closest in meaning to “intransigent”.

- A. Flexible
- B. Uncompromising
- C. Indecisive
- D. Cooperative

Q2. Choose the antonym of “deleterious”.

- A. Beneficial
- B. Harmful
- C. Damaging
- D. Pernicious

Q3. Choose the correctly spelt word.

- A. Perspicacious
- B. Perspicatious
- C. Perspicaciouss
- D. Perspicatious

Q4. A person who deliberately pretends to have beliefs that they do not actually possess is a:

- A. Hypocrite
- B. Ascetic
- C. Sceptic
- D. Stoic

Q5. Choose the word that best completes the sentence:

The committee's decision was met with _____ opposition from several members who considered the proposal impractical.

- A. tacit
- B. vociferous



- C. implicit
- D. negligible

Q6. Choose the correctly used word.

- A. The new evidence complements the theory by explaining an unexplained aspect of it.
- B. The new evidence compliments the theory by explaining an unexplained aspect of it.
- C. The scientist complimented the two findings together.
- D. The findings were complementary because they praised each other.

Q7. Choose the grammatically correct option:

Not only the researchers but also the lead scientist _____ questioned the validity of the results.

- A. have
- B. were
- C. has
- D. are

Q8. By the time the investigation concludes, the committee _____ the matter for nearly eighteen months.

- A. will have examined
- B. will examine
- C. has examined
- D. had examined

Q9. If the warning _____ taken seriously, the consequences could have been avoided.

- A. was
- B. had been
- C. would be
- D. has been

Q10. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.

- A. Neither of the explanations are entirely convincing.
- B. Neither of the explanations is entirely convincing.
- C. Neither of the explanation are entirely convincing.
- D. Neither explanations is entirely convincing.



Q11. Choose the correct option:

Were the authorities _____ the proposal, several long-term difficulties might be avoided.

- A. reconsider
- B. reconsidering
- C. to reconsider
- D. reconsidered

Q12. Identify the error:

The number of applicants / have increased considerably / since the university / revised its admission policy.

- A. The number of applicants
- B. have increased considerably
- C. since the university
- D. revised its admission policy

Q13. Choose the correct passive form:

People say that the organisation has concealed important information.

- A. The organisation is said to have concealed important information.
- B. The organisation was said to conceal important information.
- C. The organisation has said to conceal important information.
- D. The organisation is said that it concealed important information.

Q14. Choose the correct indirect speech:

The professor said, "Had I known about the discrepancy, I would have revised the paper."

- A. The professor said that if he had known about the discrepancy, he would have revised the paper.
- B. The professor said that if he knew about the discrepancy, he would revise the paper.
- C. The professor said that had he known about the discrepancy, he will revise the paper.
- D. The professor said that if he has known about the discrepancy, he would revise the paper.

Q15. Choose the correct preposition:

Her conclusions are not entirely consonant _____ the evidence presented earlier.



- A. to
- B. at
- C. with
- D. for

Q16. Choose the correct phrasal verb:

The researcher refused to _____ pressure from the funding agency.

- A. give in to
- B. give away
- C. give over
- D. give up with

Q17. The expression "a Pyrrhic victory" refers to:

- A. A victory achieved without effort
- B. A victory won at an excessive cost
- C. A victory that is unexpectedly reversed
- D. A victory achieved through deception

Q18. Choose the most appropriate word:

His argument was intellectually sophisticated but ultimately _____ because it rested on an unsupported assumption.

- A. tenable
- B. cogent
- C. specious
- D. incontrovertible

Q19. Choose the correct option:

_____ the considerable financial investment, the project failed to achieve its intended objective.

- A. Although
- B. Despite
- C. Because
- D. Whereas

Q20. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.



- A. The criteria used to assess the candidates was unnecessarily complicated.
- B. The criterion used to assess the candidates were unnecessarily complicated.
- C. The criteria used to assess the candidates were unnecessarily complicated.
- D. The criterions used to assess the candidates were unnecessarily complicated.

Q21. Choose the word closest in meaning to “obviate”.

- A. Complicate
- B. Anticipate
- C. Prevent
- D. Emphasise

Q22. Choose the antonym of “parsimonious”.

- A. Miserly
- B. Frugal
- C. Stingy
- D. Generous

Q23. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Rarely we encounter such a complex ethical dilemma.
- B. Rarely do we encounter such a complex ethical dilemma.
- C. Rarely we do encounter such a complex ethical dilemma.
- D. Rarely did we encountered such a complex ethical dilemma.

Q24. Choose the correct option:

Had the data been analysed more carefully, the researchers _____ the anomaly earlier.

- A. would detect
- B. would have detected
- C. will have detected
- D. had detected

Q25. Which word is the odd one out?

- A. Ubiquitous
- B. Omnipresent
- C. Pervasive
- D. Sporadic



Q26. Arrange the following to form a meaningful sentence:

- P. despite the apparent simplicity of the problem
- Q. requires
- R. solving it accurately
- S. considerable analytical skill

- A. P-Q-R-S
- B. P-R-Q-S
- C. R-Q-P-S
- D. Q-P-R-S

Q27. Choose the best replacement for the underlined phrase:

The committee discussed about the implications of the proposal.

- A. discussed on the implications
- B. discussed the implications
- C. discussed regarding the implications
- D. discussed over about the implications

Q28. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.

- A. It is essential that every applicant submits the required documents.
- B. It is essential that every applicant submit the required documents.
- C. It is essential that every applicant submitted the required documents.
- D. It is essential that every applicant will submit the required documents.

Q29. Choose the word that best completes the sentence:

The journalist's report was criticised for its _____ treatment of a highly complex issue.

- A. nuanced
- B. superficial
- C. comprehensive
- D. exhaustive

Q30. Choose the most appropriate formal expression.

- A. The authorities need to look into why the figures don't match.
- B. The authorities should figure out what's wrong with the figures.



- C. The authorities should investigate the discrepancy between the figures.
- D. The authorities need to check what's going on with the figures.

SECTION 2 – READING

Questions 31–40 | 1 mark each

The Paradox of More Information

The modern world has made information remarkably accessible. A question that once required hours in a library can now be investigated within seconds. Yet greater access to information does not necessarily result in better understanding.

One reason is that information is not synonymous with knowledge. Information consists of facts, observations and claims; knowledge requires those elements to be interpreted, connected and evaluated. A person may therefore consume enormous quantities of information while developing little genuine understanding.

Another difficulty is selection. Digital environments frequently present users with information that resembles what they have previously read or believed. This can create an illusion of confirmation: because similar claims appear repeatedly, they may seem more credible, even when repetition has replaced independent evidence.

The problem is not solved simply by collecting information from opposing viewpoints. Critical thinking requires examining the quality of evidence, the assumptions behind an argument and the reliability of its sources. It also requires recognising when one's preferred conclusion may be unsupported.

Consequently, intellectual independence is not achieved by knowing everything. It is developed through the ability to distinguish evidence from assertion, relevance from distraction and genuine disagreement from manufactured controversy.

In an age of abundant information, therefore, the challenge may no longer be finding something to read. It may be learning how to decide what deserves to be believed.

Q31. What is the central idea of the passage?

- A. Modern technology has made libraries unnecessary.
- B. Access to information automatically produces knowledge.
- C. Abundant information makes critical evaluation increasingly important.
- D. People should avoid information that challenges their beliefs.



Q32. According to the passage, knowledge differs from information because knowledge involves:

- A. collecting a larger number of facts
- B. interpreting and evaluating information
- C. reading information repeatedly
- D. accessing information quickly

Q33. What creates an “illusion of confirmation”?

- A. Encountering completely unfamiliar arguments
- B. Repeatedly encountering similar claims
- C. Comparing independent sources
- D. Rejecting previously held beliefs

Q34. The word “credible” most nearly means:

- A. believable
- B. complicated
- C. controversial
- D. unfamiliar

Q35. Why does the author say that simply reading opposing viewpoints is insufficient?

- A. Opposing viewpoints are always unreliable.
- B. Critical thinking requires evaluating evidence and assumptions.
- C. People should only read information they already understand.
- D. Digital platforms prevent access to opposing viewpoints.

Q36. Which statement can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Repetition alone can establish the truth of a claim.
- B. A large amount of information can coexist with poor understanding.
- C. Intellectual independence requires knowing every available fact.
- D. All disagreements are artificially created.

Q37. The author's tone is best described as:

- A. celebratory and enthusiastic
- B. analytical and cautionary
- C. humorous and informal
- D. dismissive and hostile



Q38. The phrase “manufactured controversy” most likely refers to:

- A. disagreement deliberately presented as more significant than it really is
- B. scientific disagreement between experts
- C. a debate conducted in a factory
- D. disagreement caused by a lack of information

Q39. According to the passage, intellectual independence depends primarily on the ability to:

- A. access information faster
- B. memorise competing arguments
- C. distinguish reliable evidence from unsupported claims
- D. avoid controversial topics

Q40. Which title best captures the passage?

- A. The End of Libraries
- B. The Internet and Modern Reading
- C. When Information Is Not Enough
- D. Why Everyone Believes the Same Thing

SECTION 3 – SPOKEN AND WRITTEN EXPRESSION

Questions 41–45 | 1 mark each

Q41. During a discussion, another student presents evidence that challenges your argument. What is the most appropriate response?

- A. “That evidence is irrelevant because I disagree with it.”
- B. “I hadn’t considered that evidence; it raises an important point.”
- C. “You clearly don’t understand my argument.”
- D. “My argument is correct regardless of the evidence.”

Q42. Which opening is most suitable for a formal academic email?

- A. “Hi, I need some information ASAP.”
- B. “I am writing to enquire about the eligibility requirements for the programme.”
- C. “Can you tell me what’s going on with the programme?”
- D. “Please send me everything about the programme.”

Q43. A speaker says, “I may have misunderstood your point.” Which response is most appropriate?



- A. "Obviously you did."
- B. "Perhaps I could clarify what I meant."
- C. "You weren't listening."
- D. "There's nothing to misunderstand."

Q44. Choose the most appropriate formal disagreement.

- A. "That's completely absurd."
- B. "I strongly disagree, and that's all there is to it."
- C. "While I appreciate that perspective, the available evidence suggests otherwise."
- D. "You're looking at it the wrong way."

Q45. Someone asks, "Would you be able to review this report before tomorrow?" The most appropriate response is:

- A. "Why would I do that?"
- B. "Certainly. I'll review it and share my comments tomorrow."
- C. "That's not my responsibility."
- D. "You can review it yourself."

SECTION 4 – ACHIEVERS SECTION

Questions 46–50 | 3 marks each

Q46. Choose the sentence that is grammatically correct.

- A. Had it not been for her intervention, the agreement would never have been reached.
- B. Had it not been for her intervention, the agreement would never be reached.
- C. If it had not been for her intervention, the agreement would never have reach.
- D. Had it not been for her intervention, the agreement would never had been reached.

Q47. Arrange the following sentences in the most logical order.

- P. Yet the presence of uncertainty does not necessarily make a conclusion irrational.
- Q. Scientific conclusions are often presented as provisional rather than absolute.
- R. Instead, uncertainty can indicate that researchers recognise the limits of available evidence.
- S. What matters is whether the conclusion is proportionate to the evidence supporting it.

- A. Q-P-R-S
- B. P-Q-S-R



C. Q-R-P-S

D. R-Q-P-S

Q48. Read the situation carefully:

A university introduced an automated system to evaluate initial scholarship applications. The system processed applications much faster than human reviewers. However, an audit later discovered that applicants from certain backgrounds were consistently rated lower despite having comparable academic records.

Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. Automated systems are always less efficient than humans.
- B. Faster decision-making necessarily produces better decisions.
- C. Efficiency alone is insufficient to establish that an evaluation system is fair.
- D. Human reviewers cannot make biased decisions.

Q49. Choose the sentence in which the placement of “only” most precisely conveys the intended meaning:

Intended meaning: The committee approved the proposal and nothing else.

- A. Only the committee approved the proposal.
- B. The committee only approved the proposal.
- C. The committee approved only the proposal.
- D. The committee approved the proposal only yesterday.

50. A school wants students to evaluate information encountered online. Which statement would be the strongest argument for introducing a media-literacy programme?

- A. “Students use the internet every day.”
- B. “Many schools are introducing similar programmes.”
- C. “Media literacy can help students assess sources, identify unsupported claims and distinguish persuasive presentation from reliable evidence.”
- D. “Students will probably enjoy learning about social media.”



ANSWER KEY

1. B
2. A
3. A
4. A
5. B
6. A
7. C
8. A
9. B
10. B



11. C

12. B

13. A

14. A

15. C

16. A

17. B

18. C

19. B

20. C

21. C

22. D

23. B

24. B

25. D

26. A

27. B

28. B

29. B

30. C

31. C

32. B

33. B

34. A



35. B

36. B

37. B

38. A

39. C

40. C

41. B

42. B

43. B

44. C

45. B

46. A

47. A

48. C

49. C

50. C

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